

PATNA EXPRESS

As youngsters from Bihar make their mark in the hitherto untouched world of glitz, the state Government is trying to match their global aspirations with better infrastructure

■ By Farzand Ahmed

As young men and women from Bihar make it big in the glamour world, elders from the state are sitting up and taking notice. Even as Bihar Chief Minister Nitish Kumar plans a National Institute of Fashion Technology (NIFT) campus near Patna, Bollywood actor and BJP MP Shatrughan Sinha wants to build a film city and film-maker Prakash Jha is

bringing multiplexes to a number of towns in the state.

The state Government, which has already secured the Centre's approval for a NIFT campus, has earmarked a 10-acre plot at Mithapur in Patna and set aside Rs 29 crore for the prestigious project. This comes after the start of a campus of the Birla Institute of Technology (BIT) at Mesra and the Chanakya National Law University—both in state capital Patna which

bership of the Fashion Design Council of India (FDCI).

Two years back Shahzad Kalim, 26, from Lakhisarai, a nondescript town that lies east of Patna, earned accolades and celebrity status when fashion



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▶ **NEETU CHANDRA, 22,**
ACTOR The success of *Garam Masala* has brought the south Indian industry to her doorstep

▶ **SAMANT CHAUHAN, 27,**
FASHION DESIGNER Won the first prize at the Singapore Fashion Week



▶ **DEEPA KISHORE, 18,**
SINGER Was selected to compete in *Indian Idol 3* out of a total of 5,000 aspirants

promise to open up new and refreshing opportunities for young people in a state labeled the Wild East of India.

Bihari youth who are known to dominate the civil services, technology and management institutes are now making waves in the world of music, cinema and fashion, including international fashion. Last month Samant Chauhan, 27, from Bhagalpur, a city notorious for riots and communal tension, won the Asian Young Designers Fashion Contest at the Singapore Fashion Week but, unbelievably, chose to accept the second prize of \$5,000 (Rs 2 lakh). He plans to put the money to use by setting up a design workshop and acquiring the much-needed mem-

guru Donatella Versace flew him to fashion capital Milan, Italy, for an internship under her. The bespectacled Kalim, who is a graduate from NIFT, Hyderabad, got noticed at the 2005 Lakme Fashion Week for his out-of-the-box designs. Giving the men company on the fashion scene is 24-year-old Shubhra Chaudhary from Muzaffarpur. The petite prêt designer made a mark at the recently-concluded Wills Lifestyle India Fashion Week (WIFW) with her introductory label 'Zeal' and also her philosophy "creativity with a cause".

After having taken the fashion world by storm, youngsters from the state have set their sights on the Indian

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